On Making a Commitment

Until one is committed
There is hesitancy, the chance to draw back,
Always ineffectiveness.
Concerning all acts of initiative (and creation)
There is one elementary truth,
The ignorance of which kills countless ideas
And splendid plans:
That the moment one definitely commits oneself,
Then Providence moves too.
All sorts of things occur to help one
That would otherwise never have occurred.
A whole stream of events issues from the decision.
Raising in one's favor all manner
Of unforseen incidents and meetings
And material assistance
Which no one could have dreamt
Would have come his or her way.
I have learned a deep respect
For one of Goethe's couplets:
"Whatever you can do, or dream you can -- begin it.
Boldness has genius, power and magic in it."

W. N. Murray
The Scottish Himalayan Expedition, 1951

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